



Smartphones are all the rage today as the market is oversaturated with multiple devices and this is why we test them intensively to give you the best recommendations. Learn how we do it.

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This issue of Digit has a plethora of buying guides, but let's face it, none of them are really as important as smartphones. These nifty little gadgets are what most of us buy today, irrespective of where we are and whether we're actually going to use them to their full potential. Smartphones today are powerhouses, with a lot of computing power and functionalities. For a basic user, a smartphone can actually replace a laptop and computer, allowing him or her to do everything on a smaller screen.

Also, compared to all the other tech mentioned here, smartphones are bought online most frequently. Why is this important? Because while buying online, you can't really do the tests that you can do in a retail store. Knowing the specifications is not enough, one has to actually know what they mean. Getting confused aren't you? Don't worry, we'll make all of it very clear for you. Read on!

Buying Online

While the following is meant for online buyers, the information is just as important if you're buying from a retail store.

Processor

In a PC or laptop, the processor is of the utmost importance, it ensures that you'll

get a decent experience out of your device and more importantly, that your laptop or PC will be future proof. It's not exactly that simple with smartphones. Processors become obsolete on smartphones much faster than they do on PCs, but that doesn't mean you can't future proof your device.

Speaking from personal experience, a Moto X (1st Gen) bought in 2014, is very much usable right now, and it will be till at least the next year. That doesn't mean



you should buy one right now though, not unless you're getting it at less than half of its original price. Smartphone processors ensure your phone can take everything that you throw at it. The easiest way to gauge the performance is by going through reviews, from both reviewers and device users alike.

But what happens when you can't find reviews for the phone that your heart

desires. Pick the closest competitor for comparison. For example, if you're picking the Xiaomi Mi4i, pick another device that runs on the Snapdragon 615 SoC and focus on its performance alone. It won't tell you exactly how the Mi4i will perform, but it will give you a very good idea in comparison with the competing phone. Combined with other factors, you'll be in a good position to decide whether or not to buy a particular phone.

When you're buying online, you obviously have the Internet to help. You can use this to your advantage by researching the processor on your phone of choice. What you need to look for is what generation the processor belongs to. Ideally, you want to go for a phone that has the newest processor available in a particular price bracket. If not, you can go for a generation older, if the price justifies it. For example, a Snapdragon 200 would make sense on a phone that costs ₹4,000, but not on one that costs ₹7,000.

As a rule of thumb, your phone should at least have a quad-core processor, since most dual-core processors are outdated nowadays. Apple's dual-core processors are of course acceptable, while Intel's hyperthreaded dual-core processors are also fine. Apart from that, you should avoid other dual-cores.